

Beyond Ownership: Sustaining Art as Practices and Processes

Ashley Lee Wong

This text explores the convergence of art and commerce in the creative industries, and presents an expanded notion of what might be considered ‘art’ and ‘the market’. It does not seek simply to reject the creative industries as a field whose only end is creative destruction—the facilitated exploration and acceleration of capitalism’s fragilities to strategically steer its crises into its ongoing triumphs.¹ Instead, it seeks to understand them as the field that is increasingly being made to frame art as its context, fixing it in its relation to social media, corporate interest, online and immersive experiences, all of which also contribute to a proliferation of practices. The aim is to act on this contradiction and foster practices that better enable artists and the possibilities for their work in an emerging technological milieu.

The reflections in this text represent a collection of thoughts on the emerging milieu that are in the process of coming together through practices, gathered from my experiences in the field and my work with MetaObjects,² a studio I co-founded in Hong Kong for facilitating digital production with artists and cultural institutions. MetaObjects works closely with artists and institutions in their engagement with advanced technologies while simultaneously reflecting upon them through sustained conversations. To consider the diverse realms in

1. John Hartley, Jason Potts, Terry Flew, Stuart Cunningham, Michael Keane and John Banks, *Key Concepts in Creative Industries*

(London: Sage Publications, 2013), 51–52.

2. See www.metaobjects.org.

which art circulates is to think about how art is constituted not only as objects and commodities, but as shared artistic experiences. It is important for artists and practitioners to consider how art exists collectively in thought and practice beyond individual ownership of unique and scarce objects or notions of the artist as genius, to develop a greater understanding of how art is sustained in culture, society and technology.

Art circulates in diverse economies, online and offline, as objects for sale in the art market, but also as immersive and virtual experiences within the wider creative industries. The multi-layering of temporalities in the contemporary condition³ means there is a proliferation of meanings and forms of the work of art.⁴ Artists necessarily engage diverse economies to sustain their artistic practices by circulating works as material, conceptual and digital objects.⁵ Works of art exist as conceptual works in galleries and museums; as high-valued material objects; as limited-editions sold in gift shops; as immersive art experiences; as displays on public media facades; as images shared on social media; and as financial assets and NFTs. As culture and creativity become the driving forces of the global economy, there is a pluralisation of not only practices and contexts, but also the economies for sustaining these practices.

Art acquires different meanings and values for artists, collectors and audiences according to the different 'cultures of circulation' in which it is constituted.⁶ In the post-media condition,⁷ art can take multiple forms across diverse media. With rapid technological innovation, there

3. Peter Osborne, 2018, *The Postconceptual Condition: Critical Essays* (London: Verso, 2018, 18–19.

4. This text draws from my PhD thesis on 'Emergent Economies of Art and Technology: Modes of Making, Circulating and Organising in the Contemporary Condition' (2021), and monograph titled, *Ecologies of Artistic Practice: Rethinking Cultural Economies Through Art and Technology*, The MIT Press (2025).

5. Ashley Lee Wong, 'Emergent Economies of Art and Technology: Modes of Making, Circulating and

Organising in the Contemporary Condition', PhD Diss. Hong Kong: School of Creative Media, City University of Hong Kong, 2020, 214.

6. Benjamin Lee and Edward LiPuma, 'Cultures of Circulation: The Imaginations of Modernity', *Public Culture* 14 (1), 2002: 191–213.

7. Rosalind Krauss, *A Voyage on Art in the Age of the North Sea: Post-Medium Condition* (New York, NY: Thames & Hudson, 1999); Peter Weibel, 'The Post-Medial Condition', *Arte ConTexto* no.6, 2005: 11–15.

is a diversification of technologies for the creation of artistic work. While there are attempts to define models for artists and practitioners to follow, practices have the potential to expand beyond established conventions of the art market, where the context for art is also contingent on the form of the work and vice versa. It is necessary to consider social, economic and technological systems in which work circulates as part of the artistic process itself. It is within these cultural practices that we as artists and cultural practitioners collectively constitute and give meaning and existence to the work of art.

Art in The Metaverse: Shared Experiences Over Mere Transaction

The COVID-19 pandemic only accelerated digital developments to bring more art online, with and without a physical equivalent. An online exhibition may be accessed at any time from anywhere in the world, creating an individualised experience similar to VR. What constitutes a work is its shared experience and understanding. While the digital experience suggests the immaterial existence of a work, the word ‘immaterial’ can be slightly misleading: to discuss the immateriality of digital objects suggests that they do not have a material existence. It is possible to consider instead a ‘neomateriality’⁸ as a form of ‘digital materiality’,⁹ connected to a ‘sociomateriality’,¹⁰ where objects are defined as part of social and cultural processes with data, systems and machines. As such, virtual experiences, engagements on social media, as well as real-world interactions with a work in a gallery, all contribute to the conception of the work as a whole. At times, digital objects are viewed as derivatives of original physical artworks (such as NFTs as excerpts of longer videos) or are understood as separate artworks in and of themselves, circulating in different economies and communities online and offline.

8. Christiane Paul, ‘From Immateriality to Neomateriality: Art and the Conditions of Digital Materiality’, *Proceedings of the 21st International Symposium on Electronic Art*, Vancouver, 2015.

9. Paul M. Leonardi, ‘Digital materiality? How artifacts without mat-

ter, matter’, *First Monday*, Vol.15, no.6, 2010. <https://doi.org/10.5210/fm.v15i6.3036>.

10. Wanda J. Orlikowski, ‘The sociomateriality of organisational life: considering technology in management research’, *Cambridge Journal of Economics*. Vol.35, no.1, 2010: 125–41. <https://doi.org/10.1093/cje/bep058>.



Figure 1: Cao Fei (SL avatar: China Tracy), *RMB City: A Second Life City Planning*, 2007, Machinima, Single channel video, 4:3, colour with sound, 5min 57sec. Courtesy of the artist, Vitamin Creative Space and Sprüth Magers © Cao Fei.

With time-based media, from film and video to performance art, exhibitions become spatial-temporal experiences. Even as one moves through a gallery the experience of artworks in space becomes an experience, just as in a 3D virtual gallery. Artworks can also now be sold both online and offline as equivalent spaces for the experience and purchase of art. Such visions are those embodied in the concept of the metaverse, a term coined by Neal Stephenson in his science-fiction novel *Snowcrash* (1992). The metaverse today is a techno-utopian vision to replicate the real world in the virtual realm, including all of its audio, visual and haptic possibilities of the corporeal senses, but also the economies and systems for trade of digital commodities. Our imaginaries, however, seem limited if our vision of a utopian world simply replicates the capitalist realities in which we live [fig. 1].

The metaverse involves the creation of avatars and 3D environments for our virtual existence. These fantasies of the future have risen alongside the growing interest in NFTs, which add a mechanism for the verification and ownership of digital assets, used alongside cryptocurrencies. These developments are spearheaded by an exuberance

purported by the industry and governments such as Hong Kong's Art Tech initiatives, leading to rampant investment in the field.¹¹ However, multiplayer environments and the monetisation of digital assets are not new.

Cao Fei's *RMB City* (2007–11),¹² built in Second Life, allowed real-world art collectors to be 'mayors' of the city. Users could purchase and own property in the city. The idea of a metaverse has gained more widespread attention with digital currencies and the growth of massive multiplayer online games like Fortnite, which has been used to host virtual concerts with music artists like Travis Scott.¹³ Digital objects for sale in virtual spaces are as real and valuable as material objects in a gallery. The false conception that digital is immaterial and therefore less valuable has eroded. In fact, digital assets can and will acquire value, just like any financial asset on the stock exchange, or ephemeral forms of conceptual and performative art, such as the work of Tino Sehgal. Anything can be monetised in the virtual realm and have tangible social and material effects in the world, such as one's status of wealth and prestige.

RMB City is a commentary on the fantasies (and realities) of contemporary China, the art market and capitalist societies in the digital age. It created a means to stage events both virtually in Second Life, as well as in real life with exhibitions and *RMB City Opera*, an experimental theatre play.¹⁴ In many ways, it predicted the emerging realities of the metaverse, however speculative and distant the current efforts remain. Social interactions become defined by transaction and exchange value, where the work blurs boundaries between fiction and reality [fig. 2].

Beyond a conception of the virtual realm as a new frontier for monetisation and gamification, there are efforts to create online works that do not emphasise transaction, but rather the artistic experience as 'born digital' works. Initiatives include *Slime Engine*¹⁵ from Shanghai,

11. See <https://www.info.gov.hk/gia/general/202102/24/P2021022400540.htm>.

12. See <http://rmbcity.com>.

13. See <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wYeFAIVC8qU>.

com/watch?v=wYeFAIVC8qU.

14. See <https://anthology.rhizome.org/rmb-city>.

15. See <https://www.slimeengine.com>.



Figure 2: *Afterlife:ev20f1*, NAXS Corp. & Meuko!Meuko! 2020, screenshot, <http://afterlife.zone>, ©Han-Yu Feng.

a collective of digital artists creating virtual exhibitions; NAXS Corp¹⁶ in Taiwan, who created *Afterlife*,¹⁷ a fly-through immersive experience in collaboration with musicians like Meuko! Meuko!; and DiMoDA¹⁸ (Digital Museum of Digital Art), virtual museum spaces for exhibiting digital 3D artworks, where each portal takes the user on a new spatial-temporal experience with different forms of 3D environments, objects and sounds.

Afterlife was presented as a multiplayer experience through a one-off durational event with Unsound Festival in Poland. After the event, as audience traffic subsided, the environment returned to being an individual experience. As with many of the virtual raves emerging during the pandemic, there was a desire to find shared spaces for the experience of culture in the virtual realm. They do not seek material equivalences as a ‘digital twin’, but rather attempt to expand the potential of digital environments beyond what is physically possible. The idea of ‘born-digital’ suggests creating artistic forms and shared spaces made in and for experience exclusively in the virtual realm. Artistic experiences in an online space are as ephemeral as live performances and ticketed events. It is the collective memories shared in

16. See <http://naxs.tech>.

17. See <http://afterlife.zone>.

18. See <https://dimoda.art>.

conversations, online chats, social media, reviews and artistic communities that contribute to the meaning and existence of the work of art as a temporal experience.

Service Provisions, Moving Beyond Ownership

While the virtual realm sees rampant commercialisation through the metaverse, cryptocurrency and NFTs, we have also seen the increasing commercialisation of art in general. In the UK, the art and cultural sectors have faced increasing privatisation since the 1980s.¹⁹ The 2008 economic crisis only accelerated the convergence of art and commerce as public funding was cut during long periods of austerity. Artists and institutions had to find new ways to support artistic practice. The corporate sector became more open to artistic collaborations as part of their marketing agendas. Corporate sponsorship is not new: fashion brands like Chanel have a history of collaborating with artists, while technology companies like Bell Labs and their engineers have supported art and technology collaborations through programmes like Experiments in Art and Technology (E.A.T) since the 1960s.²⁰ Commercial collaborations have proliferated with initiatives like BMW Art Journey Award, HTC Vive Arts, Facebook Artist-in-Residence etc. Art plays a role in diverse commercial agendas contributing to branding, innovation and corporate social responsibility. This includes decorating the Facebook offices, while employees may also engage with artists to enrich their worldview.²¹ These commercial opportunities provide important resources for artists to continue and sustain their practices. Rather than transforming artworks into commodities as products for sale and purchase, art becomes a ‘service provision’, as Andrea Fraser (1994) put it, as a way of engaging artists in a labour process [fig. 3].²²

19. Chin-tao Wu, *Privatising Culture: Corporate Art Intervention since the 1980s* (London, UK: Verso, 2002).

20. E.A.T. was founded in New York in 1967 as a non-profit to facilitate collaborations between artist and engineers from Bell Laboratories. Their large-scale experimental immersive projects included the Pepsi Pavilion at Expo '70 in Osaka, Japan, which is

among the early examples of technology companies and commercial corporations facilitating art and innovation through research and funding.

21. See <https://www.artsy.net/article/artsy-editorial-artist-residence-facebook>.

22. Additional artwork credits: 3D-printing support: Andrew Crowe © MetaObjects; Engineering: Raymond Chan and Ivan Lai © Crevice Design



Figure 3: Samson Young, *Big Big Company (Mini Golf)*, 2019, 3D-printed PLA, resin, plywood, artificial turf, single-channel video, K11 Musea, Hong Kong, Photo ©MetaObjects.

The private sector is playing a larger role in patronage through artist commissions and residencies,²³ creating opportunities for artists in lieu of public funding. While art brings symbolic value to luxury products, artists also gain from a wider audience for their art and often larger fees. Sponsorship often provides a more secure funding mechanism in contrast to under-funded non-profit institutions, who may expect artists to work for low fees on a ‘labour of love’.²⁴ While there are expectations to make work that appeals to a wide audience or that are easily marketable, there are equally expectations for projects financed with non-profit funding to benefit the aims of social inclusion and

Studio; 3d models: ‘Venus de Milo (Aphrodite of Milos)’ & ‘Discobolus (The Discus Thrower)’, SMK National Gallery of Denmark © Turbosquid; ‘The Three Graces at the Hermitage Museum, Russia’ & ‘Michelangelo’s David in the Accademia di Belle Arti of Florence, Italy’, Peter Edwards (Cool3DModels) © Thingiverse & CC by 2.0; ‘Robin the thinker’, lampmaker © Thingiverse, CC by 2.0; ‘The Thinker at the Musée Rodin,

France’, Bruce Stevens © Thingiverse, CC by 2.0; ‘Marsyas’, The Metropolitan Museum of Art © Thingiverse, CC by-sa 3.0.

23. See <https://www.theatlantic.com/business/archive/2018/10/brand-patrons/568153/>.

24. Miya Tokumitsu, *Do What You Love: And Other Lies About Success and Happiness* (New York, NY: Regan Arts), 2015.

diversity. Disillusionment with government arts funding is reflected in Hong Kong in the face of increasing censorship, but also a general frustration with bureaucracy. The application process over-determines the outcomes of a project, often hindering an open-ended creative process. Digital studios and artists like onformative, Andreas Nicolas Fischer and FIELD, whose practices straddle the design field, find greater possibilities working commercially with brands, rather than seeking validation from museums and institutions or the competitive and comparatively small amounts of grant funding.

In Hong Kong and Mainland China, art malls have become a model for the exhibition of art. This phenomenon emerged partly as a means to bring art to the public who may not be accustomed to visiting museums. In particular, K11's culture-retail empire created a role for contemporary art as a means to target aspirational socially networked millennials. Just as malls are looking more like museums, museums are looking more like shopping malls with gift shops, restaurants and blockbuster exhibitions. Artworks add to the experience of malls as objects of wonder to share on social media. In the case of K11, artists are paid significant sums to produce new work²⁵ in ways that many public funders do not. While art serves as marketing and promotion of products, brands are becoming more attuned to the interests of artists by providing creative freedom to produce, while recognising how 'authenticity' sells. The K11 Musea opened in 2019 for instance, features public artworks and installations throughout the mall. The works range from public art sculptures by renowned artists like Katharina Grosse, to commissions by artists, such as Samson Young's 3D printed mini-golf course, as works that are playful and accessible to wide audiences as just one part of their practice.

Another example is Will Benedict's Summer 2020 campaign for Balenciaga²⁶ with music by experimental music group, Wolf Eyes, whose cyber-dystopian newscasts unsettle more than they sell. Commercial

25. In my PhD thesis, I discuss the work of Samson Young and his view on collaborating with enterprises like K11. In the face of situations where artists are often exploited, K11 has a reputation for paying artists well and on time to produce work. It also cares for the presentation of the work by

collaborating with experienced curators, and has a deep understanding of the artistic process, though will generally only accept work that is accessible to wider audiences.

26. See <https://www.vogue.com/article/balenciaga-spring-2020-campaign-news-will-benedict-artist>.



Figure 4: Will Benedict, Balenciaga Summer 20 Campaign, 2020, screenshot by Ashley Lee Wong.

collaborations provide important opportunities for artists to create new work. An interest in corporate aesthetics and branding by post-internet artists is a response to this convergence of art and commerce. The double ontology of the artwork is where the image exists both as branding and as an artwork in and of itself. Art participates in perpetuating the market whether it acknowledges it or not. It has become fully entwined within our contemporary economies [fig. 4].

While we often do not consider the images of artworks circulating on social media as artworks in and of themselves,²⁷ these images continue to participate in the understanding of what constitutes the work of art. These are the only encounters with an artwork that many people will have. An image circulating online contributes to the recognition of the work and its cult value. It builds cultural significance for an artwork in our collective memories as something that exists as user-generated content. This interest in the ability to circulate on social media is what Hito Steyerl refers to as the 'poor image'.²⁸ The potential of an

27. Though there are situations where images on social media are artworks, forms of internet art or social media interventions, such as Amalia Ulman's *Excellences and Perfections* (2014).

28. Hito Steyerl, 'In Defense of the Poor Image', *e-flux Journal*, no.10, 2009, <https://www.e-flux.com/journal/10/61362/in-defense-of-the-poor-image/>.

image to go viral begins to influence the form of artworks conceived of as highly Instagrammable installations and selfie-friendly exhibitions. The power of images to circulate in a promotional economy is shaping today's cultural landscape, where art plays a role in personal brand-building, alongside a potential to produce differential effects. To hone our senses is to understand the different existences that a work may have for different people in different contexts. An image may simultaneously operate as an advertisement and an artwork with complex beings participating in different registers of image-making. How can we enable images to circulate, while cultivating and sharing experimental art and ideas in a hyper-mediated society?

The traditional art market of material objects continues to exist within museums, galleries, auctions and art fairs. However, an economy of temporal agreements through licensing exists alongside the art market of objects. License agreements allow for the reproduction and distribution of copyrighted images (or concepts) for a limited period of time. These may be for specific exhibitions or as reprints of images on posters or T-shirts. Conceptual art also employs licensing in the artist contract²⁹ to define the artwork and dictate the terms of use of work such as restaging the work in an exhibition or its resale. Due to the reproducibility of digital media, licensing is better suited for digital works, where copies are just as original as the original. NFTs essentially act as a contract and licence to own and use a work. They are the financial objects that constitute and legally define the artwork and its ownership. The materiality of the work becomes less important than the terms. The proof of ownership or certificate of authenticity becomes separated from the art objects, which are able to circulate freely as 'poor images' online, but also as highly valued works in galleries and ownable digital assets [fig. 5].

Beyond an economy of ownership, media-based works may be licensed for screenings or display on large media facades, such as Times Square's Midnight Moment in New York, or commercially supported displays by brands like Samsung. Art may be mistaken for advertising, just as advertising is also becoming closer to art. Art may serve as advertising

29. Such as Seth Siegelaub and Robert Projansky's *The Artist's Reserved Rights Transfer And Sale Agreement*. See <https://>

primaryinformation.org/product/siegelaub-the-artists-reserved-rights-transfer-and-sale-agreement/.



Figure 5: *teamLab Borderless: MORI Building DIGITAL ART MUSEUM* in Odaiba, Tokyo, which closed in August 2022 prior to its reopening in central Tokyo as part of the Azabudai Hills project expected to complete construction in 2023. Credit: teamLab, *Universe of Water Particles on a Rock where People Gather* © teamLab.

in the promotion of a potential ‘creative city’ in municipal agendas. It provides a highly accessible canvas for artists whose practices are better suited to large screens than the white cube gallery. These displays are a form of licensing, which simply permits the showing of a work. They do not engage the artist further in a process of creation, unless they require site-specific modifications or are presented as specially commissioned works.

Moving away from an economy of the ownership of objects, galleries are presenting installations as experiences. While some may be presented as ticketed experiences with paid entry, such as with international art collective teamLab’s immersive museum³⁰ teamLab

30. teamLab Borderless in Tokyo opened in 2018 as a 10,000 square metre immersive museum, where audiences were free to wander the space filled with interactive digital artworks and become part of the work. Following its closure in 2022, the museum has reopened in central Tokyo. Artworks respond to users’ movements and interactions with

different spaces, as well as with other artworks. The work is colourful, playful and child-friendly, creating works akin to spectacular entertainment. See <https://borderless.teamlab.art/>. The teamLab Borderless museum opened in Shanghai in 2019, in Jeddah in 2024, and opens in Hamburg in 2026.



Figure 6: Andrew Luk × Samuel Swope: *Ready|Set|Fulfill*, 2021 © Andrew Luk © Samuel Swope, courtesy De Sarthe, Hong Kong.

Borderless and the *Rain Room* by Random International,³¹ they follow a model closer to cinema and theme parks. While individual objects may be sold from an installation, an economy of licensing the entire exhibition becomes a way to move beyond the centrality of objects in the art market. An example is de Sarthe Gallery in Hong Kong, whose exhibition *Ready/Set/Fulfill* (2021) by Andrew Luk and Samuel Swope³² features a drone racecourse, packaged as a touring exhibition with accompanying race events. The artists are paid to reinstall and present the work as site-specific installations. As a form of service, this provides artists with a legal framework to defend their labour conditions, rather than abstractions of value of art objects. The cost of purchasing the entire installation would be much higher,³³ and only a museum would have the knowledge and resources to care for such a work, which creates greater uncertainty

31. In 2013, Random International presented the highly popular *Rain Room* at MoMA, New York, <https://www.moma.org/calendar/exhibitions/1352>. The work features rain falling in a room where users are tracked while walking in the space so that the water does not fall on their heads, but surrounds them with drops.

32. See <https://www.desarthe.com/exhibitions/readyssetfulfill.html>.

33. Through conversations with former Director of de Sarthe Gallery at the time Willem Molesworth, who described how the work was to be distributed and sold.

around its sale and remuneration. Licensing initiates a process of restaging the work as a site-specific display [fig. 6].

While commercial commissions and sales come with their own limitations, we must also consider how they may enable artists to pursue experimental and non-commercial practices within a wider art ecology. Whether the practice is commercial or non-profit becomes less important as diverse economies are mutually entwined. Commissioning remains connected to a labour process; money retains its ‘use value’ (Commodity-Money-Commodity or “C-M-C”)³⁴ where artists are ‘put to work’, rather than solely for the accumulation of capital. Money is not an end goal in and of itself, but something that enables the continuation of a process. Commissioning in this sense is more valuable for artists because it provides an opportunity for them to continue their practice. Selling work is a transaction that does not necessarily lead to a continuation of a process (nor does licensing for display on a facade). Artists may ‘cash out’ where money is the end goal as ‘exchange value’ (Money-Commodity-Money or “M-C-M”).³⁵ Proceeds may also be used to support an artist’s living, but this does not require the artist to make new work, instead serving for individual benefit. Licensing has the potential to enable a process of restaging a work to sustain artistic activities as a collective endeavour. Rather than encouraging the collecting of art to be held in vaults, it ensures that art acquires cultural value when it is shared. Art collecting becomes meaningful when collectors participate in stewardship in displaying the work in exhibitions, or in developing a supportive relationship with artists. Collecting art can be more than a mere transaction, where the meaning and conception of art is constituted in relationships. To take care is to tend to these possible relations, constituting art and people and their roles and identities, enabling its existence.

Through this lens, we can also look at how residencies and commissions enable and sustain a process of art making. An example is the Thoughtworks Arts Residency³⁶ in New York, which ‘incubates artists

34. Karl Marx, [1867], *Capital: A Critique of Political Economy*. Ben Fowler trans. (London: Penguin Books, 1976), 247–48.

35. Ibid.

36. See <https://thoughtworksarts.io/>. Thoughtworks is a multi-national technology company founded in 1993 in Chicago. The three pillars of the company, as mapped out by the

and technologist collaborations to investigate the impacts of emerging technologies on industry, culture and society'.³⁷ Thoughtworks' engineers support art and technology projects that engage with topics such as AI bias and social justice in collaboration with industry. To be able to negotiate between the interests of artists and the corporation can be challenging, though there are ways to continue to find and create spaces where art projects can be supported and thrive. As such, our work with MetaObjects is fluid, bridging gaps in knowledge and between sectors of art, technology and academia. Through a shared process of discovery, we aim to support artists and institutions in iteratively and collectively learning with technologies along the way. Our work is not defined by what we are as a studio, but by how we find ways of working within an emerging milieu.

Concluding Thoughts for Future Reflections

Beyond an economy for the ownership of commodities, the creative industries can be treated as a framework to tactically consider how to support artists in continuing their practices and enabling an engagement with art that can endure in time. This includes an engagement with technologies as a long-term commitment that can deepen the possibilities not only for art but that can pose critical questions for technology that challenges irrational exuberance. It can also challenge concepts of the art market centred around finite, commodifiable and unique art objects and open up possibilities outside of the modernist conceptions of art that these objects affirm. Objects and objecthood become less important than the social and cultural processes surrounding the work and the infrastructures and protocols beneath it. Art becomes participation in processes of care by which we sustain and nurture the practices and communities that can orient us differently in relation to large-scale technological advances. An economy of objects can still play a role in these processes if we consider how we congregate around objects, including digital objects as commodities, and the relations between artists and collectors. It must also

company's Chief Scientist Martin Fowler, include: Sustainable Business, Software Excellence and Social Justice. See <https://martinfowler.com/bliki/ThreePillars.html>.

37. <https://thoughtworksarts.io>.

necessarily involve passing on knowledge or skill about the creation of the work through generations, where the sale of artworks operates to sustain artistic practices over time, rather than as an end in itself.

Acknowledgements

Thanks to the editors and Emily Verla Bovino for their review and comment on this text.

References

- Fraser, Andrea. 'How to Provide an Artistic Service: An Introduction'. In *Vienna: The Depot*, 1994. <http://web.mit.edu/allanmc/www/fraser1.pdf>.
- Hartley, John, Jason Potts, Terry Flew, Stuart Cunningham, Michael Keane and John Banks. *Key Concepts in Creative Industries*. London: Sage Publications, 2013.
- Krauss, Rosalind. *A Voyage on Art in the Age of the North Sea: Post-Medium Condition*. New York, NY: Thames & Hudson, 1999.
- Marx, Karl. [1867]. *Capital: A Critique of Political Economy, Volume One*. Ben Fowler trans. London, UK: Penguin Books, 1976.
- Lazzarato, Maurizio. 'Immaterial Labour'. In *Radical Thought in Italy: A Potential Politics*. Edited by Paolo Virno and Michael Hardt. Minneapolis, MN: University of Minnesota Press, 1996.
- Lee, Benjamin, and Edward LiPuma. 'Cultures of Circulation: The Imaginations of Modernity.' *Public Culture* 14, Vol.14, no.1, 2002: 191–213.
- Leonardi, Paul M. 'Digital materiality? How artifacts without matter, matter'. *First Monday*, Vol.15, no.6, 2010. <https://doi.org/10.5210/fm.v15i6.3036>.
- Orlikowski, Wanda J. 'The sociomateriality of organisational life: considering technology in management research.' *Cambridge Journal of Economics*, Vol.34, no.1, 2010: 125–41. <https://doi.org/10.1093/cje/bep058>.
- Osborne, Peter. *The Postconceptual Condition: Critical Essays*. London: Verso, 2018.
- Paul, Christiane. 'From Immateriality to Neomateriality: Art and the Conditions of Digital Materiality'. *Proceedings of the 21st International Symposium on Electronic Art*, Vancouver, 2015.
- Steyerl, Hito. 'In Defense of the Poor Image'. *e-flux Journal* 10, 2009. <https://www.e-flux.com/journal/10/61362/in-defense-of-the-poor-image/>.
- Tokumitsu, Miya. *Do What You Love: And Other Lies About Success and Happiness*. New York, NY: Regan Arts, 2015.
- Weibel, Peter. 'The Post-Medial Condition'. *Arte ConTexto*, no.6, 2005: 11–15.
- Wong, Ashley Lee. 'Emergent Economies of Art and Technology: Modes of Making, Circulating and Organizing in the Contemporary Condition'. PhD Diss., Hong Kong: School of Creative Media, City University of Hong Kong, 2020.
- Wu, Chin-tao. *Privatising Culture: Corporate Art Intervention since the 1980s*. London: Verso, 2002.